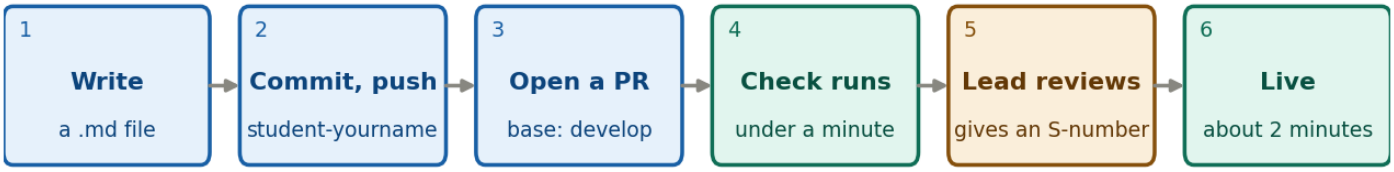
From note to live page

NSDF-Data student cheat-sheet · version 5, 19 October 2026

A one-page reminder. The full steps are in guide 3, writing a note and guide 4, publishing a note. **Nothing is public until your lead merges your pull request (PR).**



Blue: you. Teal: GitHub, automatically. Amber: your lead. A PR is a page on GitHub that asks to add your branch to the project.

Before you push

- Your note is `notes/src/your-note-name.md`, your pictures are in `notes/src/img/`, the header is complete, and it says `id: "TBD"`.
- Every link to your code is pinned to a **commit hash**: not `develop`, `master` or `COMMIT`. Remove the template's `img/example.png` line, and any <u>, <sup>, <sub> or tags.
- Optional: with your environment active, run `python tools/build_notes.py check`. It finds the problems the PR check would. Then run `python tools/check_note_numbers.py notes/src/your-note-name.md`: it lists the numbers in your text that are not in your notebook's output.

Commands, from the `NSDF-Data` folder, on your own branch:

```
git checkout student-yourname
git add notes/src/your-note-name.md notes/src/img
git status              # only your note and its pictures? no .bin files, no idx folder?
git commit -m "Add note: your title"
git push -u origin student-yourname
```

Then open the repository on github.com, click **Compare & pull request**, check that the **base** is `develop`, and click **Create pull request**.

If the check says… (click **Details** on the check to read it)

Message	What to do
`header field 'X' is missing or empty`	Fill in that line of the header.
`status must be one of ...`	Use exactly *In progress*, *Complete* or *Superseded (reference/link)*.
`notebook link pinned to 'master'`, or `placeholder COMMIT is still in the note`	Use the real commit hash.
`raw HTML tag <u>` (or <sup>, <sub>,)	Remove the formatting, keep the words.
`picture not found`	Check the file name, and that it is in `notes/src/img/`.

Fix it on your branch, commit and push again. The PR updates itself and the check runs again.

After that. Your lead reads the note, may comment on the PR (answer there), and gives it a note number when it is ready. About two minutes after the merge your page is live, in the **Analysis Notes** table on the front page, in order of its number. To change a published note, first run `git switch student-yourname && git pull origin develop` and check that the header still has your note number (not `TBD`); then commit, push and open a new PR, update the date, and never delete a note to hide a mistake.

Never work on `master` or `develop`, or commit data (`.bin` files, the `idx` folder) or other people's notes. Stuck? Write to Anthony Villano, anthony.villano@ucdenver.edu, with the PR number, the check's message and the step you are on.